Applications commonly need to display collections of formatted entries. A blog might show a series of articles, each with text, author, date, and so on. A store might display entries in a catalog, where each has an image, a description, and a price.

The `:collection` parameter to `render` works in conjunction with the `:partial` parameter. The `:partial` parameter lets us use a partial to define the format of an individual entry, and the `:collection` parameter applies this template to each member of the collection.

To display a list of article model objects using our previously defined `_article.html.erb` partial, we could write this:

```
<%= render(partial: "article", collection: @article_list) %>
```

Inside the partial, the local variable `article` will be set to the current article from the collection—the variable is named after the template. In addition, the variable `article_counter` will have its value set to the index of the current article in the collection.

The optional `:spacer_template` parameter lets you specify a template that will be rendered between each of the elements in the collection. For example, a view might contain the following:

rails7/e1/views/app/views/partial/_list.html.erb

```
<%= render(partial:          "animal",
           collection:      %w{ ant bee cat dog elk },
           spacer_template: "spacer")
%>
```

This uses `_animal.html.erb` to render each animal in the given list, rendering the partial `_spacer.html.erb` between each. Say `_animal.html.erb` contains this:

rails7/e1/views/app/views/partial/_animal.html.erb

```
<p>The animal is <%= animal %></p>
```

And `_spacer.html.erb` contains this: